

such as instant messengers, security programs, etc. The taskbar now displays live thumbnails when you roll your mouse over the buttons for the windows. It wins over the dock in this aspect because though the dock displays live thumbnails too, they are much smaller than the thumbnails in Vista.



Compare this to Exposé

When you hit the “Show Desktop” button on the taskbar, all the windows are minimised to show you the desktop. But when you select a single window from the taskbar or launch something new, the other windows stay minimised. That is, if you have fifteen windows open, you have to click on all fifteen of them individually to restore them. On Mac OS X, the [F11] shortcut will show your Desktop and bring back all the windows, no matter what you do in between.

### 5.3.2 The Dashboard

One of the most important additions to Tiger was the Dashboard application. It is primarily a different layer from the OS X desktop that appears and goes away as the user desires. This layer has a bunch of self-contained, mini applications called “widgets” that perform some specific and highly specialised tasks. So the weather widget fetches up-to-date weather forecasts from the Internet, the world clock displays the time of cities around the world, the calendar widget is just concerned with making sure you know all about dates—you get the idea. The default widgets bundled with Dashboard are Address Book, Business, Calculator, Calendar, Dictionary, ESPN, Flight Tracker, Google, iTunes, People, Ski Report, Stickies, Stocks, Tile Game, Translation, Unit Converter, and Weather.

It’s pretty handy because every time you want to know the temperature outside, you simply invoke the Dashboard with the click of a key or a flick of the mouse—and there you have it. The